



GUIDELINES ON APPLICATION FOR DHET UNIVERSITY CAPACITY DEVELOPMENT GRANT (UCDG)

1. BACKGROUND

The Strategic Initiatives and Administration (SIA) unit oversees the University Capacity Development Grant (UCDG) program of the Department of Higher Education and Training (DHET) Research Capacity Development projects. The DHET strictly monitors and conducts an external audit of the UCDG's component on research capacity development. As a result, only the grant's intended purposes may be carried out, and the distribution of funds must be open and transparent. The funds must be managed in accordance with UJ's governance and financial policies.

As far as possible, the structures and processes already established in faculties will be utilised to manage the application process. Thus, faculties will manage the approval processes, ensure that proposed outcomes and envisaged impact stated in motivations for funds are met, and provide reports for the DHET via the Strategic Initiatives and Administration unit.

2. PURPOSE OF THE GUIDELINES

The purpose of this document is to provide guidelines on the application process and disbursement of the funds for successful applications under the Research Capacity Development projects of the DHET University Capacity Development Grant.

3. APPLICATION PROCESS

- The call for applications will be issued as soon as the DHET transfers funds to UJ and will close on November 30th, subject to funds availability. Thus, the call will remain open until November or until all funds are depleted, whichever comes first.
- Applications will be processed on a first-come, first-served basis when the online application is routed to the fund administrator.
- All applications and required supporting documents must be submitted online.
- Due to the limited funding, only one UCDP application per person will be funded per year.
- Applicants that received UCDP funding are expected to report on the outputs derived from the funding. Previous funding received does not guarantee future funding
- Applicants must follow up on the status of their applications with all relevant approval parties to ensure that the application reaches the fund administrator on time.

APPLICANT → HoD → HoS/VICE DEAN / EXECUTIVE DEAN / DIRECTOR → STRATEGIC INITIATIVES & ADMIN

NOTE: Applicants will only be considered if a feedback report was submitted with proof of the measurable outputs if previously supported.

The DHET approved the following seven research development projects for funding. The funding can be used for research development of academic staff (Permanent/Fixed term) only.

Project 1 **Improvement of staff qualifications:** Supporting academic staff (Permanent/Fixed term) to complete qualifications, with special reference to doctoral qualifications.

The grant will cover the following related costs: teaching relief/replacements and financial assistance e.g., costs of transcription, data analysis, binding, editing, travel to other HEIs where staff are registered.

The Post Graduate School is offering coaching sessions for individuals and/or cohort groups.



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- Project 2 **Research career development of emerging and mid-career researchers:** Applicants in this category would be academic staff (Permanent/Fixed term) emerging and mid-career researchers who plan to improve academic profile, in various areas that require improvement to become established academic researchers. The grant will cover - Teaching relief/replacement for completion of research project/publication; presentations of research papers at accredited international conferences; hosting of research development workshops.
- Project 3 **Professionalisation of academic and research staff:** Applicants in this category would be academic staff (Permanent/Fixed term) who plan to increase their research output in preparation for application for NRF rating, promotion and to enhance their research profile. The grant will cover applications for writing for publication retreats and individual writing consultations with research specialists. For participation contact Post Graduate School: rcducdp@uj.ac.za
- Project 4 **Supervision development:** The objective of the project is to increase the number of academic staff (Permanent/Fixed term) attending supervision enrichment workshops, the Postgraduate Supervision Forums, or those enrolling for the formal UJ supervision courses hosted by the Post Graduate School. For participation contact Post Graduate School: supervisioncourse@uj.ac.za
- Project 5 **International collaboration & networking (Permanent/Fixed term):** Opportunities for international travel and accommodation for research collaborations aimed at strengthening research collaborations and partnerships. **This project does not accommodate presentation at international and national conferences**
- Project 6 **Providing integrated student support and development to postgraduate students:** This project focuses on programmes, interventions and resources designed to improve postgraduate retention and time to completion of Master's and doctoral studies, and to promote quality research outputs, as well as to develop 'soft' skills/(post)graduate attributes that contribute to employability.
- Presented by Post Graduate School the project will offer: Research capacity development workshops; online courses and/or resources for postgraduate students; Research writing support. For participation contact Post Graduate School: rcducdp@uj.ac.za.
- Project 7 **Women Leadership Development Programme:** The Research Leadership Programme (RLP) is a 12-month programme, specifically aimed at developing research leadership for outstanding female academic researchers with an academic profile equivalent to NRF C and Y ratings, to accelerate their advancement towards becoming world-renowned scholars (the equivalent of NRF A- & B-rated scholars). For participation contact Strategic Initiatives and Administration office: SIA@uj.ac.za

No applications for DHET funding will be processed if not completed in full, approved by HoD, HoS/Vice Dean or Executive Deans and ALL required supporting documentation attached.



3.1 Criteria for application

- The purpose of the funds is to develop research capacity in staff studying towards masters and doctoral qualifications, and 'emerging' researchers and supervisors. The category 'emerging' has been defined as 'recent doctorate recipient') but, given the nature of the academic staff complement in a comprehensive university, some flexibility needs to be allowed, with the Executive Deans making the final decisions on who qualifies as 'emerging researcher'.
- Support is available only to **permanent or fixed-term academic staff**, except in the case of participation in workshops or short learning programmes that are organised by the Postgraduate School, faculties, schools or departments at UJ, where other staff members may be included in the group benefitting from the intervention at the discretion of the applicant (such as the HoD), and only if space allows.
- The principle of co-funding applies: applicants are expected to explore other sources of funding (research funds; departmental funds; faculty funds; external sources) and to detail what funding is available from other sources. – UCDP is unlikely to fund projects/activities in full.

3.2 Measurable outputs/outcomes

Outcomes of allocated funds should be clear and measurable outputs, products or impacts; for example, research output such as a journal article, or evidence of substantive progress towards completing a qualification, such as data collection, or submission of specified chapters of the dissertation or thesis.

3.3 Support from supervisor

It is recognised that supervisors have an important role to play in determining the development needs and progress of their postgraduate students. Therefore, the support of the supervisor is required where applicable. A written motivation should accompany the online application.

3.4 Supporting documentation

Section 13 lists the DHET required supporting documents, which should be attached when submitting online.

3.5 Recommendations

Faculties and departments processes should be followed.

- The 1st recommendation is done by the HoD and should consider the application and examine the funding/project applied for, including the supporting documentation.
- The Executive Dean/Executive Director or Vice-Dean (if this function has been delegated to a Vice-Dean or Head of School - FEDE) should be the second signatory.

4. TEACHING RELIEF

Only academic staff appointed in a permanent or fixed-term capacity can apply for teaching relief. Replacement lecturers and tutors/markers are to be paid at the current UJ HR rates per hour. In the case of academics studying towards masters or doctoral degrees, applications for teaching relief should be accompanied by proof of registration and a workload schedule.

Once the replacement lecturer has been appointed, the applicant must send the following documents to ucdp@uj.ac.za as proof of appointment:

- HR appointment letter.
- A certified copy of the Highest Qualification.
- A certified copy of ID or passport.



5. MENTORING/COACHING

Mentoring/coaching applies only to fixed term or permanent academic staff. It should be noted that there is a difference between mentoring and coaching and that the specific type of support required should be indicated on the form. A detailed description of the service, as well as a CV of the proposed mentor/coach should be attached to the form. It is assumed that retired academics may be an important resource in this regard. In the case of the service being requested for a staff member who is a master's student or doctoral candidate, the supervisor/s should also support the application and the written motivation/s should be attached to the application email.

6. WRITING RETREAT, WORKSHOP OR SHORT COURSE FACILITATION

This support is intended for a group of staff members from a specific faculty, school or department. It would usually be initiated by a Dean, Head of School or HoD. Although it is accepted that experienced and established researchers may also benefit from writing retreats, workshops or short courses, a significant proportion of the group should be emerging researchers, emerging supervisors, master's students or doctoral candidates. Clear preference for attendance should be given to such candidates. A motivation and a description of the measurable outputs or impact expected from the intervention should be clearly articulated in the form. A detailed description of the content and form of the specific writing retreat, workshop or short course should be attached.

7. PARTICIPATION IN WORKSHOP, SHORT COURSE OR CONFERENCE,

This support applies to educational interventions that are offered by other higher education institutions and reputable companies. Only academic staff members who have insufficient funds in research accounts and who have used their departmental and faculty allocations are eligible to apply for this support. There must be clear outputs or impacts associated with the application. Acceptable outputs include: completion of a master's or doctoral qualification or an accepted peer-reviewed journal article. The applicant is responsible for providing a complete budget and the output details to Strategic Initiatives and Administration.

These funds may also be used for development of emerging supervisors. The supervisor of a master's student or doctoral candidate should support the application and the written motivation should be scanned and attached to the application. Detail regarding the planned intervention should be attached to the application.

8. APPROVAL

Final approval of applications by the Strategic Initiatives and Administration Unit will depend on the application meeting the set grant criteria and the availability of funds. Applications will be approved on a first-come, first-served basis. However, consideration will be taken to attain equitable allocation of funds across faculties.

9. GOVERNANCE

The DHET funding has been entrusted to UJ in order to achieve the explicit goal of growing and developing the next generation of academics. Allocation and management of the funding must be done according to equitable, transparent and auditable processes. UJ financial and other administrative processes and policies (eg. UJ's Travel Policy; UJ rates for temporary staff etc.) must be followed and due diligence must be applied to ensure that the intended objectives and impacts are achieved. The applicants' responsibility is to ensure that procurement deadlines are met to ensure timely payment.

10. MANAGEMENT OF ACHIEVEMENT OF OUTCOMES

It is not the intention of the Strategic Initiatives and Administration (SIA) Unit to manage the intended performance or delivery associated with the interventions funded through the DHET UCDG grant. However, it is expected that feedback/reporting be provided to SIA as outlined below.



Reporting Achievements

- DHET requires the University to report on how allocated funds are spent as well as the outcomes of financial assistance granted through UCDG.
- All UCDG award recipients are required to provide financial reports, supporting documents, and reports that describe the accomplishments made possible by UCDG funding.
- The DHET may request additional reports from mentors/supervisors and delegated authority that approved the grant application.
- All reports should be submitted online for audit purposes

11. Administration And Payment

- All applications must be submitted online. Feedback will be provided within three (2) weeks of SIA receiving the application.
- Internal transfer of approved funds will be done within three (5) days of approval.
- Payment will be limited to the initial application amounts approved, and funds must be used in accordance with the approved activities.
- The UCDP provides funding for the academic year. Funds awarded must be spent by the end of the year, and a financial report must be submitted.

12. Items not funded by the DHET-UCDG

- Daily subsistence
- Equipment of any nature
- Miscellaneous expenses
- Car hire without motivation
- Teaching relief (Lecturing) in December

13. Supporting Documentation

The following is a list of the documentation that must be submitted with the UCDG application:

Presentation of research paper at accredited international/national conference

- Proof of conference paper acceptance
- Conference registration costs
- Detailed excel budget

National/International travel

- 3 x Flight quotation(s) - Economy class only
- 3 x Accommodation quotation(s) - 3 star only
- Detailed excel budget

Car Rental (Exceptional cases only)

- 3 x Car Rental quotation(s)
- Motivation for car rental for DHET's approval
- Detailed excel budget

Teaching Relief

- Replacement staff's identity document & proof of highest qualification
- Lecturing/Teaching schedule
- Detailed excel budget
- Once the replacement lecturer has been appointed, the applicant must send the following documents to ucdp@uj.ac.za as proof of appointment:
 - HR appointment letter.
 - A certified copy of the Highest Qualification.

- A certified copy of ID or passport.

Financial support e.g. Binding, Editing, Data analysis etc.

- Proof of cost (quotation/invoice)
- Detailed excel budget

Support to completing master's or doctoral degree

- Proof of registration
- Supporting letter from supervisor regarding progress
- Detailed excel budget

Writing retreat, workshop, or short course facilitation

- A detailed description of the content
- Detailed excel budget

Workshop, short course, or conference

- A detailed description of planned intervention
- Detailed excel budge